

Tharindu Harith Withana (Harith) (he/him)

Melbourne, VIC

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PROFILE

Motivated Master's in Artificial Intelligence student at RMIT Melbourne with 4+ years of experience in data science and machine learning. Skilled in building scalable ML solutions, leading cross-functional teams, and collaborating on global projects. Passionate about ethical AI, agile product development, and innovation for social good.

KEY SKILLS

- Programming: Python, R, Java, MySQL,
- Data Science: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, NLP, Computer Vision, LLMs
- Data Visualization: Tableau, PowerBI
- Tools & Platforms: GitHub, Jupyter, MongoDB (NoSQL), CI/CD Pipelines, REST APIs
- Cloud Services: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, ECR, API Gateway, Sagemaker), Azure (incl. OpenAI)
- Project Management: Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, Stakeholder Engagement

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

RMIT University - Master in Artificial Intelligence

2024-2025

- Coursework : Practical Data Science with Python, Big Data Processing, Social Media Analysis, AI, Programming Autonomous Robots, Cloud Computing, Computational ML, Deep Learning
- Minor Thesis : "Using Large Language Models to Simulate Users to Analyse Music Recommendations"
- [RMIT Big Industry Challenge Melbourne \(Sept 2024\)](#) : Team Leader for the Micro Internship

National Institute of Technology Durgapur - B. Tech in Computer Science and Engineering - First Class.

2015-2019

- Capstone project : Detecting the handwritten texts on letters (the address) using OCR and deep learning.
- Awarded Rajiv Gandhi Memorial Scholarship Indian Council for Cultural Relationship (ICCR) India for Sri Lankan Nationals through University Grant Commission, Sri Lanka.

Coursera & other certifications

2017-2022

- AI for Medical Diagnosis course on Coursera [2022], "Deep Learning Specialization" course on Coursera [2020]
- Project based training on "Core Java" in MTA India, and recognized as Microsoft Technology associate for Software Development Fundamentals [2017]

WORK EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer | Integra Technology Solutions

July 2025 - Present

- Leverage and fine-tune LLMs and ML to automate document processing and insight extraction.
- Build microservices for each AI feature to enhance user experience, integrating MongoDB (NoSQL) and AWS S3 for scalable data handling.

Project Lead | Omdena

Apr 2024 - Jan 2025

Omdena is the world's largest grassroots AI organization. <https://www.omdena.com/>

- Led team of 2 developers to optimize gender and social inclusion (GESI) conversation analysis in Sri Lanka
- Defined product goals, facilitated stakeholder communication, and managed agile sprints
- Delivered actionable insights to NGO partners

Machine Learning Engineer | Intermediate Data Systems

Sep 2023 to Feb 2024

IDT is a South African based IT consulting company which I got the chance to work with through Omdena top-talents. <https://www.linkedin.com/company/intermediate-data-systems/>

- Our client was an insurance company where they already had 5 major issues, and we as AI engineers initially had to figure out solutions and scope and then started prioritizing the projects.

- I worked on the project to help our client with matching their customers for their marketing campaigns: **customer segmentation**/profiling and right party & when to contact.
- We used LLM with **RAG** to enhance their chatbot for their client interactions using Azure OpenAI.

Data Scientist | EngenuityAi

Jul 2021 to Feb 2024

Data Analytics & AI start-up in Sri Lanka <https://www.engenuityai.com/>

- Promoted to Senior Data Scientist; led a team developing an environmental conservation platform using remote sensing, computer vision, and ML (AWS-deployed), in collaboration with government bodies and University of Colombo professors, generating over **\$20M in revenue**.
- Built ML models for **sales forecasting** and created interactive dashboards for a local beverage client.
- Developed a computer vision-based vehicle insurance app that auto-generates accident reports from user-uploaded images.

ML Engineer | Omdena

June 2020 to April 2023

<http://www.omdena.com>

- Omdena is the collaborative platform consisting of Data Scientists from all around the world to build innovative, ethical, and efficient AI and Data Science solutions to real-world problems.
- TrashOut Project - <https://omdena.com/blog/illegal-dumping/> : I use computer vision to identify the type of trash and suggest where to dump it. Identify and forecast illegal dumping sites using ML.
- WRI Project : Analyzing and tracking the clients' contributions using their platforms and recommending their future projects using NLP, Recommender Systems and Machine Learning. <https://medium.com/omdena/climate-change-visualizations-from-words-to-actionable-insights-60f9b7dcc17c>
- HRI Project : Social media scraping and human rights violations analysis using NLP and providing an interactive dashboard using NLP and Machine Learning.

Jr Data Scientist | LB Finance PLC

Feb 2020 to July 2021

LB Finance PLC is Sri Lanka's leader in innovative financial services.

- Work with stakeholders throughout the organization to identify opportunities for leveraging company data to drive business solutions.
- Mine and analyze data from company databases to drive optimization and improvement of product development, marketing techniques, and business strategies.
- Use predictive modeling to enhance customer experiences, optimize revenue generation, ad targeting, and drive cost savings across business operations.
- Built interactive Tableau dashboards to track, visualize, and analyze model outcomes in real time.

Software Engineering Trainee | HDFC Bank

May 2018 to June 2018

<https://www.hdfc.lk/>

- In my internship I worked on their System Software Development using ASP.Net in Visual Studio and Oracle DB, developing extensions required for their existing systems.

EXTRA-CURRICULARS & PERSONAL INTERESTS

- Cricketer – **RMIT Cricket Club & Whittlesea Cricket Club**
- Swimmer, AI Ethics Enthusiast, Community Builder
- Chief Organizer – NITPL 2024 Cricket Tournament at NIT Durgapur India

VOLUNTEERING

- **WellFed Victoria** – Food Preparation Volunteer
- **RUSU Queer Department (RMIT University)** – Community Volunteer
- **RUSL Club (RMIT University)** – Event Coordinator
- **Arohan Festival (NIT Durgapur India)** – Volunteer

REFEREES

- Mohan Ganavarapu (Director and Senior Consulting Engineer - [Adroit Engtech](#))
- Dr Aditya Joshi - School of CSE, UNSW

*Contact informations can be provided upon request